ADV 115

ADVOCACY, ACTIVISM, PETITIONING

Advocacy comes from the latin word 'Advocare', meaning to call to one's aid.
Advocacy is the systematic & strategic process of influencing public policies, societal attitudes, institutional policies.

TYPES OF ADVOCACY

1. Self Advocacy
2. Peer Advocacy
3. Group Advocacy
4. Policy Advocacy:
5. Legal Advocacy

ESSENTIAL ELEMENTS OF ADVOCACY

1. Clear identification of an issue
2. Evidence based arguments.
3. Defined objectives
4. Strategic communications
5. Engagement with relevant authorities
6. Persistence

Advocacy is intelligent, structured and purposeful.

EPR 113

COURSE TITLE: PROFESSIONAL ETHICS & ADVOCACY

Introduction:
It is a course that examines moral principles, standards and conducts expected in professional practice especially within the legal profession. It also studies communication, persuasion and representation techniques used by professionals in defending clients, promoting justice & influencing decisions.

This course exposes students to:

- Ethical standards in professional lives
- Relationship between law & morality
- Duties of lawyers & professionals
- Communication and advocacy skills
- Public speaking & persuasion techniques

TOPICS UNDER EPR 113

1. Canon of ethics & law versus ethics
2. Lawyer & client relationship
3. Basic communication skills & key elements
4. Public speaking and advocacy techniques

Ethics refers to moral principles that guides human behaviour & determine what is right or wrong. Ethics help individuals & professionals make responsible decisions.

Ethics is concerned with; Honesty, integrity, fairness, accountability, respect for others.

EXAMPLES OF ETHICAL CONDUCTS

- Telling the truth
- Respecting confidentiality (boundaries)
- Avoiding corruption
- Acting fairly
- Law refers to rules and regulations established by the government or authority to regulate behaviour within the society. Law is enforceable by government and violation attracts punishment.

FUNCTIONS OF LAW

a) Maintenance of peace and order
b) Protection of rights
c) Prevention of crimes
d) Promotion of justice
e) Resolution of dispute

1.**Canon of Ethics:** It is a formal set of principles and standards guiding members of a profession.
In the legal profession, canon of ethics direct lawyers on:
a) Professional Conduct
b) Relationship with clients
c) Conduct in court
d) Relationship with colleagues

SOURCES OF ETHICS

Ethics may come from:
a) Religion
b) Culture & tradition
c) family upbringing
d) Educational institution
e) Professional obligation
f) Society

CHARACTERISTICS OF ETHICS

- Ethics is moral in nature
- It guides personal behaviour
- It promotes discipline
- It encourages responsibility
- It protects professional reputations.

DIFFERENCE BETWEEN LAW & ETHICS

LAW	**ETHICS**
1.) Law is made by government.	Ethics is based on morality.
2.) It is legally binding.	It is morally binding
3.) It is punishable by Court.	It is punishable by society or professional bodies.
4.) Law is written, modified and sealed.	Ethics may be unwritten.
5.) Law applies generally.	Ethics apply morally and professionally.

RELATIONSHIP BETWEEN LAW AND ETHICS.

Law and ethics are closely related because both regulate human conduct.

- Ethics influence law
- Law may reflect societal morals
- Ethics fills gaps where law is silent

IMPORTANCE OF PROFESSIONAL ETHICS

a) It promotes public trust
b) It maintains professional dignity
c) It encourages honesty
d) It prevents corruption
e) It protects clients and society
f) It ensures accountability

JCY 111

LEGAL PRECEDENT

A legal precedent is a previous decision of a court, that is used as authority for deciding subsequent cases with similar facts or legal issues. This helps to ensure consistency and predictability of the law.

CASE LAW

This refers to a body of law developed through judicial decisions rather than through legislation.

While legislative bodies write formal laws called statutes, the courts interpret and build upon those rules through judicial decisions known as case law.

DOCTRINE OF STARE DECISIS

The foundation of legal precedent is the doctrine of Stare Decisis, a Latin phrase meaning “To stand by things decided”.

This means that it is required of a court to follow earlier decisions of higher courts when the facts of the cases are similar.

LDR 101

STRATEGIES FOR POLITICAL POSITIONING AND BRANDING

Brand is a unique name, design, symbol or feature that distinguishes one seller's goods or services from competitors.

Branding is the intentional process of shaping how the public and your target audience perceive your business or life.

FUTO's political structure is broken into three:

i. The grassroots
ii. The kings
iii. The king makers

i. **The Grassroots:** The general student population, departmental blocks, and hall residents. This is your foundation and the source of raw voting power.
ii. **The Kings:** The current leaders, executives, and constitutional figures who hold formal authority.
iii. **The Kingmakers:** The strategic influencers, stakeholders, coalition leaders, and power brokers who command blocks of votes and sway opinions behind the scenes.

THE FIVE PILLARS OF PERSONAL POLITICAL VALUE

To effectively brand yourself, you must build and project strength across five critical dimensions of soundness:

- **Spiritually Sound:** Having a solid moral compass, ethical grounding, and alignment with values that command respect and trust.
- **Academically Sound:** Maintaining strong academic standing. In an environment like FUTO, academic competence is a massive source of political legitimacy.
- **Intellectually Sound (Smart):** Demonstrating sharp problem-solving skills, emotional intelligence, articulate communication, and the ability to debate or strategize on your feet.

- **Physically Sound:** Projecting vitality, charismatic presence, excellent presentation, and the sheer stamina required to endure grueling political campaigns.
- **Financially Sound:** Having the personal capacity or the strategic network to fund campaigns, print materials, support grassroots mobilization, and sustain political operations.